

Vello-5™

Topical Solution 5% w/v

COMPOSITION

Each ml contains 50mg of Minoxidil (5%w/v).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

The mechanism by which minoxidil stimulates hair growth is not fully understood, but minoxidil can reverse the hair loss process of androgenetic alopecia by increasing the diameter of the hair shaft, stimulating anagen growth, prolonging the anagen phase and stimulating anagen recovery from the telogen phase. As a peripheral vasodilator, minoxidil enhances microcirculation to hair follicles. The Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor (VEGF) is stimulated by minoxidil and VEGF is presumably responsible for the increased capillary fenestration, indicative of a high metabolic activity that observed during the anagen phase.

PHARMACOKINETICS

About 0.3 to 4.5% of a topical dose of minoxidil is absorbed from intact scalp. Minoxidil is not bound to plasma proteins. It is distributed into breast milk. Minoxidil is extensively metabolised by the liver. It requires sulfation to become active, but the major metabolite is a glucuronide conjugate. Minoxidil is excreted predominantly in the urine mainly in the form of metabolites. Minoxidil and its metabolites are dialysable, although the pharmacological effect is not reversed.

INDICATION

Vello-5 is indicated to stimulate hair growth and is used in the treatment of hair loss (alopecia androgenetica).

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

For topical use only.

Hair and scalp should be thoroughly dry prior to topical application.

Apply 10 sprays (1ml) at a time, 2 times a day to the areas of baldness or hair loss. Massage scalp gently with fingertips. The total dosage in a day should not exceed 20 sprays (2ml). Fingertips are used to facilitate drug application, hands should be washed afterwards.

The method of application varies according to the disposable applicator used:

Pump spray applicator: this is useful for large areas. Aim the pump at the centre of the bald area, press once and spread with fingertips over the entire bald area. Repeat for a total of 10 times to apply a dose of 1 ml. Avoid breathing spray mist.

Extended spray-tip applicator: this is useful for small areas, or under hair. The pump spray applicator must be in place in order to use this additional applicator. Use in the same way as the pump spray.

It may take twice daily applications for two months or more before evidence of hair growth can be expected. Users should discontinue treatment if there is no improvement after one year.

If hair regrowth occurs, twice daily applications are necessary for continued hair growth. Anecdotal reports indicate that regrown hair may disappear three to four months after stopping the application of minoxidil solution and the balding process will continue.

CONTRAINDICATION

The 5% minoxidil solution is not recommended for women.

Not to be used by those who are known hypersensitivity to Minoxidil.

Should not be applied to inflamed scalp skin or areas affected by psoriasis, severe sunburn, or severe excoriations, because of the risk of increased absorption.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

Topical minoxidil is only indicated for the treatment of alopecia androgenetica and should not be used in other types of hair loss for example when there is no family history of hair loss, hair loss is sudden and/or patchy, hair loss is due to childbirth, or the reason for hair loss is unknown. Topical application of minoxidil should be restricted to the scalp.

Patients being treated for hypertension should be monitored if topical minoxidil is used concurrently.

Minoxidil topical solution 5% w/v will cause burning and irritation of the eye. In the event of accidental contact with sensitive surfaces (eye, abraded skin, mucous membranes), the area should be bathed with copious amounts of cool tap water.

Use in Children:

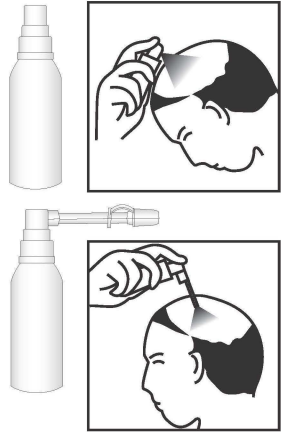
Safety and efficacy of minoxidil topical solution 5% w/v in patients under 18 years of age have not been established.

Use in elderly:

Safety and efficacy of minoxidil topical solution 5% w/v in patients over 65 years of age have not been established.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

Should not be used concomitantly with other medications applied topically on the scalp. Topical drugs, such as corticosteroids, tretinoin, dithranol or petrolatum, which alter the stratum corneum barrier could result in increased absorption of minoxidil if applied concurrently. Although it has not been demonstrated clinically, there exists the theoretical possibility of absorbed minoxidil potentiating orthostatic hypotension caused by peripheral vasodilators.



PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

This product should not be used during pregnancy or lactation.

Pregnancy

There are no adequate and well-controlled studies in pregnant women. Studies in animals have shown a risk to the foetus at exposure levels that are very high compared to those intended for human exposure.

Lactation

Systemically absorbed minoxidil is secreted in human milk. The effect of minoxidil on newborns/infants is unknown.

SIDE EFFECTS

Topical application of minoxidil may be associated with contact dermatitis, pruritus, local burning, and flushing; sufficient may be absorbed to produce systemic adverse effects. Changes in hair colour or texture may occur.

Immune System Disorders

Common: Hypersensitivity reactions (including face oedema, generalised erythema, pruritus generalised, swelling face, and throat tightness).

Not known: Angioedema (including lip oedema, lip swelling, oedema mouth, oropharyngeal swelling, pharyngeal oedema, swollen tongue and tongue oedema).

Psychiatric Disorders

Not known: Depressed mood.

Nervous System Disorders

Very common: Headache.

Uncommon: Dizziness.

Eye disorders

Not known: Eye irritation.

Cardiac disorders

Common: Chest pain.

Uncommon: Palpitations.

Not known: Heart rate increased.

Vascular disorders

Not known: Hypotension.

Respiratory, thoracic and mediastinal disorders

Uncommon: Dyspnoea.

Gastrointestinal Disorders

Uncommon: Nausea.

Not known: Vomiting.

Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders

Common: Hypertrichosis (unwanted non-scalp hair including facial hair growth in women), Pruritus (including rash pruritic generalised and eye pruritus), Rash (including pustular, popular, generalised, vestibular and macular rash), Dermatitis (including contact, allergic, atopic and seborrhoeic dermatitis).

Rare: Changes in hair texture.

Not known: Dry skin, Skin exfoliation (including exfoliative rash and dermatitis exfoliative), Acne (acneiform rash), Temporary hair loss, Changes in hair colour.

General disorders and administration site conditions

Common: Oedema peripheral.

Not known: Application site reactions (These sometimes involve nearby structures like the ears and face and typically consist of pruritus, irritation, pain, rash, oedema, dry skin, erythema and rash erythematous but can sometimes be more severe and include exfoliation, dermatitis, blistering, bleeding and ulceration).

Investigations

Common: Weight increased.

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT FOR OVERDOSAGE

Increased systemic absorption of minoxidil may potentially occur if higher than recommended doses are applied to larger surface areas of the body or areas other than the scalp.

Accidental ingestion has the potential of producing systemic effects related to the pharmacological action of the drug (2ml of Vello-5 contains 100 mg minoxidil; the maximum recommended adult dose for oral minoxidil administration in the treatment of hypertension). Signs and symptoms of minoxidil overdosage would primarily be cardiovascular effects associated with sodium and water retention. Tachycardia hypotension, dizziness and lethargy can also occur.

Treatment of minoxidil overdosage should be symptomatic and supportive.

Fluid retention can be managed with appropriate diuretic therapy. Clinically significant tachycardia can be controlled by administration of a beta-adrenergic blocking agent.

STORAGE CONDITION

Store below 30°C.

SHELF LIFE

The expiry date is indicated on the packaging.

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION, DOSAGE FORM AND PACKAGING AVAILABLE

Colourless to slightly yellow transparent liquid, with a weak, ethereal, vinous odour.

Available in pack size of 60ml.

For further information, please consult your physician or pharmacist.

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Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder

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